Akka vs. Salesforce Agentforce

A comparison for teams building agentic AI

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Agentforce is a SaaS application-layer agent bound to the Salesforce platform and data model — excellent inside Salesforce, but not a general-purpose agentic runtime. It is priced by consumption (per-action Flex Credits or per-conversation) or per user, its agents are grounded in Salesforce CRM metadata and Data 360 (formerly Data Cloud), and its governance runs through the Einstein Trust Layer and MuleSoft Agent Fabric, with EU AI Act support limited to published guidance. The Akka Agentic AI Platform runs any cross-system workload on a fixed annual fee, guarantees resilience and scalability, and embeds EU AI Act enforcement in the runtime.

No SLA	99.9999%	Up to 90%	1,718
AGENTFORCE CONTRACTUAL UPTIME	AKKA SLA	CHEAPER TO OPERATE ON AKKA	CONTROLS AKKA GOVERNS TO

DIMENSION	SALESFORCE AGENTFORCE	AKKA
What it is	A SaaS application-layer agent platform inside the Salesforce ecosystem	The Akka Agentic AI Platform — guarantees resilience and scalability
Scope	Agents grounded in Salesforce CRM metadata and Data 360; external systems reached via Flow / API callouts and A2A through MuleSoft Agent Fabric	General-purpose runtime for any agentic workload, across any system
Platform dependency	Add-on to Salesforce licenses; Data 360 is a technical prerequisite	None — Akka cloud, any hyperscaler VPC, your Kubernetes, on-prem, sovereign cloud
Availability SLA	No contractual uptime SLA; standard Main Services Agreement "commercially reasonable efforts"	99.9999% — entire platform, backed by indemnities
RTO / RPO	Not published for the agent layer	Sub-1-minute RTO; zero-byte RPO; active-active HA/DR
Cost model	Consumption — Flex Credits (20 credits / $0.10 per action) or $2 per conversation; per-user add-ons $125–$150 a month with unmetered employee use	Shared compute; up to 90% lower infrastructure for the same workload; fixed annual fee
Governance / EU AI Act	Einstein Trust Layer — toxicity/bias detection, zero data retention, audit trail, no masking for agents; MuleSoft Agent Fabric policies for agents on any platform; EU AI Act guidance only	Aspect-woven runtime enforcement + full pre-production governance (241 regulations and frameworks / 1,718 controls)
Build audience	Salesforce admins / developers in Agentforce Builder & Agent Script	Two independent lifecycles — build (PM/dev/ML/domain) and govern (risk/security/compliance)
Certifications	Salesforce trust / compliance program	19 standards (SOC 2 II + public SOC 3, ISO 27001/42001, HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR, NIS2, DORA, EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF)

A SaaS Application-Layer Agent vs. a General-Purpose Runtime

Agentforce is an application-layer agent platform built into Salesforce. Its agents are written in Agent Script in Agentforce Builder, compiled into an Agent Graph, and executed by the Atlas Reasoning Engine — grounded in Salesforce CRM objects and Data 360

(formerly Data Cloud). That is what makes it excellent inside Salesforce, and what bounds it there. Salesforce describes a four-layer stack: a Data layer (Data 360), an Application layer (CRM objects and business logic), an AI/Model layer (Einstein models, the Atlas Reasoning Engine, and third-party LLMs), and an Agent layer (salesforce.com). Agentforce reaches non-Salesforce systems through Flow, API callouts, and A2A connections from MuleSoft Agent Fabric, but orchestration, reasoning, and state live inside Salesforce — "the goal is to make data available in Salesforce" (salesforceben.com).
Akka is not an application; it is the runtime an agentic system runs on — native agents, durable in-memory state, real-time streaming, an API layer, orchestration, observability, and governance as one platform, for any workload, independent of any single SaaS data model.

Capability	Agentforce	Akka
Agents inside the Salesforce ecosystem	Native, deeply integrated	Runs alongside via APIs
General-purpose runtime for any agentic workload	Bounded to Salesforce; external systems via Flow/API and A2A	Built in — any system
State / reasoning location	Inside Salesforce (CRM metadata, Data 360)	Durable in-memory, vendor-neutral, 4ms / sub-10ms
Platform prerequisite	Salesforce license + Data 360	None
Deploy on your own infrastructure	No — Salesforce-hosted SaaS	Akka cloud, hyperscaler VPC, Kubernetes, on-prem, sovereign

Availability and Disaster Recovery

Agentforce does not publish a contractual availability SLA for the agent layer. Salesforce's standard Main Services Agreement (September 2026 version) commits to **"commercially reasonable efforts"** to make the online services available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, with no numeric uptime guarantee and no service credits for downtime (Salesforce MSA).

Metric	Agentforce	Akka
Contractual availability SLA	None published; "commercially reasonable efforts"	99.9999%
Service credits	None under standard MSA	Backed by indemnities
RTO / RPO	Not published for the agent layer	Sub-1-minute RTO / zero-byte RPO
SLA scope	—	The entire platform

Akka owns the SLA across the entire platform, with active-active HA/DR across regions and 24/7 SRE.

Up to 90% Cheaper to Operate

AI systems built with Akka are up to **90% cheaper to operate** than Python-based systems — a function of the infrastructure required for the same agentic transaction volume, not list price. The drivers are actor concurrency (~10 trillion tokens per core per year vs ~2 trillion; ~80% less compute than Python frameworks), shared compute, and micro-checkpointing. Manulife reported up to 300% more concurrency and 30–50% faster processing after porting from Python (akka.io/blog/go-slow-to-go-fast).

Agentforce is priced by **consumption**. Under Flex Credits a standard action costs 20 credits — $0.10 at $500 per 100,000 credits; an alternative Conversations model bills $2 per conversation, and the two cannot coexist in one org. Per-user add-ons at $125 a user a month ($150 for Industries) cover unmetered employee use (salesforce.com/agentforce/pricing). The meter moves with usage. Akka runs everything on one shared-compute runtime for a fixed annual fee finance can forecast.

Real-Time Streaming at Petabyte Scale

Akka streaming is built into the runtime — continuous, backpressured, **petabyte-scale, in-memory**, with no external broker — powering both agent feedback loops and high-throughput data processing (the engine behind Tubi's real-time hyper-personalization at 5 billion tokens per second).

Agentforce, as a SaaS application-layer product, has no comparable general-purpose streaming runtime; data movement runs through Salesforce platform services and Data 360, inside the Salesforce ecosystem.

Continuous AI Intelligence

Akka Optimize keeps improving the AI after it ships. It runs an evaluation loop on your own production traffic, grading live interactions and training smaller specialized models on your proprietary data, so the system keeps getting better as it runs. The loop delivers three results that compound over time:

- **Model leverage** — route each request to the best model from any vendor under your policies, and reserve frontier models for the requests that need them.
- **Data sovereignty** — the specialized models are trained on your proprietary data, owned by you, and run inside your own environment.
- **Cost governance** — full visibility and control of AI spend, with savings that compound as the loop keeps running.

The evaluations run continuously inside Akka and grade traffic from agents wherever they run, in Akka or in third-party harnesses.

Governance: Trust Layer, Agent Fabric, and the EU AI Act

Agentforce governs through the Einstein Trust Layer: toxicity and bias detection, a zero-retention LLM gateway, and an audit trail, with data masking disabled for agents. MuleSoft Agent Fabric extends Salesforce governance to agents built on any platform, with access, tool, and spend policies, Rogue Agent Detection, and an Agent Kill Switch. Salesforce supports the EU AI Act with published guidance that asks each customer to map its own systems; neither the Trust Layer nor Agent Fabric classifies a system against the Act before deployment.

The penalties are enforceable now

Violation	Maximum Fine
Prohibited AI practices (Art. 5)	EUR 35M or 7% global turnover
High-risk obligations (Art. 9-15)	EUR 15M or 3% global turnover

High-risk AI carries a 10-year logging-retention obligation (Art. 72); the penalties apply to the whole AI system, not only the part inside Salesforce.

How Akka governs

At the runtime: inline guardrails, policies, LLMs-as-a-judge, and sanitizers; hash-chained immutable evidence; HITL/HOTL control; atomic PII scrub-with-explain; pre-deployment classification against **241 regulations and frameworks and 1,718 controls** (699 carrying a financial penalty); multi-persona sign-offs; a sealed Governance Posture Package; and Akka Verify proving conformance from the running system — for any workload, not only the part inside a single SaaS application.

Two Lifecycles, One Certified System

Building on Agentforce means Salesforce admins and developers authoring agents in Agentforce Builder and Agent Script; there is no co-equal, independently versioned governance lifecycle owned by risk and compliance. Akka runs two independent lifecycles on one platform via **Akka Specify**:

BUILD LIFECYCLE

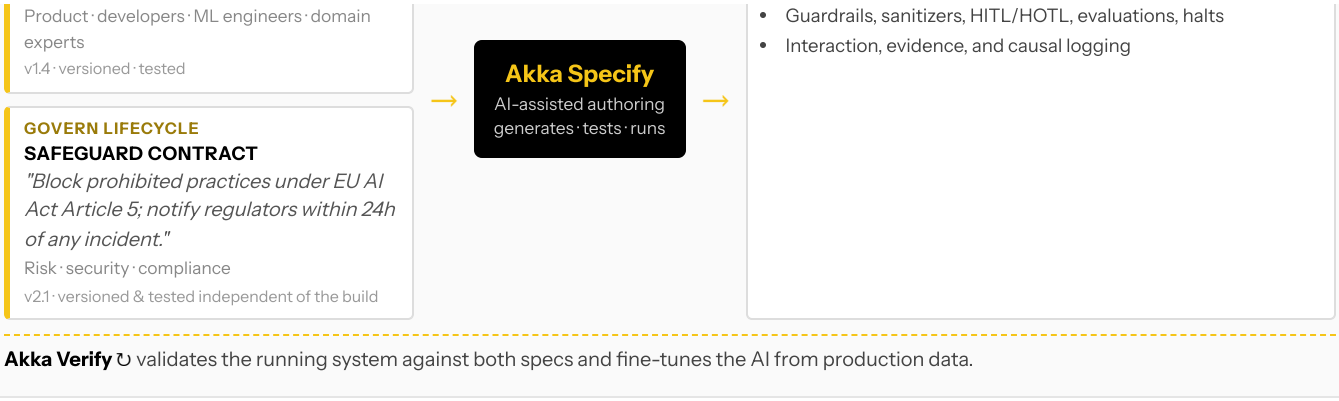
FUNCTIONAL CONTRACT

"Rank incoming ER patients by acuity and route the top three to a clinician."

ONE CERTIFIED AI SERVICE

Built, governed, and running

- Agents, tools, orchestration, memory, APIs, streaming, UI



The build lifecycle and the governance lifecycle are versioned and tested independently, by different audiences — a workflow Agentforce has no equivalent for.

For the Buyer: Product Maturity, Lock-In, and Accountability

Salesforce the company is durable; the question is the **Agentforce product**. Agentforce 360 reached general availability on February 23, 2026, in the Spring '26 release, introducing Agentforce Builder, Agent Script, Agentforce Voice, and Intelligent Context (ciodive.com). The product is young and moving fast — the authoring model and the pricing model are both recent. Standardizing on it means accepting that maturity curve and the platform lock-in below.

Buyer concern	Agentforce	Akka
Product maturity	Agentforce 360 GA Feb 2026; long-horizon runtime and Koa reasoning model in pilot as of Dreamforce, Sep 2026	since 2009, 100,000+ production deployments, 52 banks
Platform lock-in	Add-on to Salesforce licenses; Data 360 a technical prerequisite; agents bound to the Salesforce data model	No platform dependency; portable specs; deploy anywhere incl. sovereign cloud
Workload scope	Excellent inside Salesforce; external systems via Flow/API and A2A	Any agentic workload across any system
Availability accountability	No contractual SLA; standard MSA "commercially reasonable efforts"	One platform, one SLA, 24/7 SRE — Akka owns the running system
Certifications & audits	Salesforce trust / compliance program	19 standards — SOC 2 II + public SOC 3, ISO 27001/42001, HIPAA, PCI DSS, GDPR, NIS2, DORA, EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF — plus annual pen tests, SBOMs, 40+ policies (trust.akka.io)
Budget predictability	Consumption metering that scales with usage, or per-user add-ons	Fixed annual fee finance can forecast

The decision is scope and accountability: Agentforce is the right agent for work that lives inside Salesforce; Akka is the runtime for agentic systems that must span systems, carry a contractual SLA, govern to the EU AI Act broadly, and run on infrastructure you choose.

Customers Running Agentic and Real-Time Systems on Akka

Manulife
2,000
developers across 100 projects on one governed platform

Tubi
5B tok/s
real-time hyper-personalization engine

Swiggy
71ms
order-assignment AI, ~50% latency reduction

John Deere
1,000+
tractor sensors turned into real-time insight

Verizon
750%
order-processing capacity gain; 6s → 2.4s response

Common Questions

We already run Salesforce. Why add Akka?

Agentforce is excellent for agents that operate inside Salesforce, grounded in your CRM data. If you are building agentic systems that span multiple systems of record, need a contractual availability SLA, or must govern to the EU AI Act across the whole system, those are

Is Agentforce cheaper because it's part of our Salesforce contract?

Agentforce is a paid add-on: Flex Credits at $0.10 per action (20 credits), $2 per conversation, or per-user add-ons at $125–$150 a month, on top of the required Salesforce platform and Data 360

runtime concerns Agentforce does not cover. Akka runs alongside Salesforce and provides the general-purpose runtime.

Doesn't Agentforce already handle the EU AI Act with the Einstein Trust Layer?

The Einstein Trust Layer provides toxicity and bias detection, a zero-retention gateway, and an audit trail, and Salesforce disables its data masking for agents. MuleSoft Agent Fabric adds gateway policies for agents on other platforms. The EU AI Act applies to the entire AI system and expects pre-deployment high-risk classification, which Salesforce leaves to the customer. Akka embeds these inline and covers pre-deployment governance against 241 regulations and frameworks and 1,718 controls.

licenses. The meter scales with usage. The Akka shared-compute runtime is up to 90% cheaper to operate for the same agentic transaction volume, on a fixed annual fee.

Can Agentforce run our agents outside Salesforce?

Agentforce can call external systems through Flow, API callouts, and A2A, but the reasoning, orchestration, and state live inside Salesforce, and Data 360 is a technical prerequisite. For agentic workloads whose center of gravity is outside Salesforce — or that must be portable across clouds and on-prem — Akka provides a vendor-neutral runtime with no platform dependency.

Sources

Agentforce pricing: g2.com/products/salesforce-agentforce/pricing; jitendrazaa.com — Flex Credits ~$500/100k credits, standard action 20 credits ($0.10), Conversations $2/conversation, models cannot coexist in one org (2026)

Agentforce architecture: salesforce.com/agentforce/what-is-a-reasoning-engine/atlas; developer.salesforce.com — Atlas Reasoning Engine (graph-based), Agent Script compiled into an Agent Graph (architect.salesforce.com); four-layer stack (Data 360 / Application / AI-Model / Agent)

Agentforce scope / lock-in: salesforceben.com/how-does-salesforces-agentforce-work; titandxp.com; redresscompliance.com — add-on to Salesforce licenses, Data 360 technical prerequisite, external systems via Flow/API

Agentforce 360 GA: ciodive.com; salesforce.com/agentforce/what-is-new — GA Feb 23, 2026 (Spring '26): Agentforce Builder, Agent Script, Agentforce Voice, Intelligent Context

Salesforce SLA: Salesforce_MSA.pdf (Main Services Agreement, Sept 2026) — "commercially reasonable efforts," no contractual uptime commitment, no service credits

Einstein Trust Layer: salesforce.com/eu/artificial-intelligence/trusted-ai; getgenerative.ai; gettectonic.com — toxicity/bias detection, zero-retention LLM gateway, audit trail; data masking disabled for agents (trailhead.salesforce.com)

Updates checked 2026-10-26: salesforce.com/agentforce/pricing — Flex Credits $500/100k, 20 per action, 30 per voice action, Conversations $2, add-ons $125/$150 per user per month with unmetered employee use; Salesforce_MSA.pdf (Sept 2026) — "commercially reasonable efforts," no service credits; trailhead.salesforce.com (Einstein Trust Layer; data masking disabled for agents; Data 360 required for all Agentforce use); salesforce.com/ap/data/guide — Data 360, formerly Data Cloud; architect.salesforce.com hybrid-reasoning guide — Agent Script compiled to an Agent Graph run by Atlas; docs.mulesoft.com/general/agent-fabric-overview — Agent Fabric governance, A2A; salesforce.com/blog/dreamforce-2026-announcements — long-horizon runtime, Koa, Agent Optimizer; salesforce.com/blog/guide-to-eu-ai-act — EU AI Act guidance.

Akka performance: akka.io/blog/go-slow-to-go-fast — Manulife up to 300% more concurrency, 30–50% faster; ~10T vs ~2T tokens/core; ~80% less compute than Python

Akka platform: 99.9999% availability, active-active HA/DR, sub-1 min RTO, zero byte RPO (contractual indemnities); 241 regulations and frameworks / 1,718 controls / 699 with a financial penalty; 100,000+ deployments / since 2009; profitable; Dell Technologies Capital

Akka trust center: trust.akka.io — 19 compliance standards; SOC 2 II + public SOC 3; annual pen tests, SBOMs, 40+ policies